



SUMMER VISITORS

The summer flush of vegetation attracts herds of caribou, which migrate north to feed on the plants and breed. The plant and insect life also attracts flocks of birds, especially shorebirds and waterfowl like these snow geese. They fly north to the tundra to nest and raise their young, then fly south again when the temperature drops and the snow starts to fall.



UNDER THE SNOW

At the end of summer, most birds and many of the big animals move south. Small mammals, such as voles and lemmings, stay on. Living in the grass beneath the snow protects them from the bitter winter chill. They are hunted by predators like this snowy owl, which can hear them moving under the snow.

SNOW SURVIVORS

Larger animals such as Arctic hares that spend the winter on the tundra shelter from the worst of the weather in snow burrows. But they feed in the open, where they risk being caught and eaten by wolves and Arctic foxes. The wolves also prey on the musk oxen (right) that stay on the tundra all year round. They are protected from the freezing winds by layers of fat and their long hairy coats.



BLOODSUCKING SWARMS

Tundra bog pools make ideal nurseries for the aquatic young of mosquitoes and blackflies. Later in the summer, the adults emerge in swarms that attack any animals they can find, driving caribou to higher ground to escape them.



▲ BLOOD MEAL

Female mosquitoes like this one must drink blood to make their eggs. The males feed on flower nectar.